



HEAVY INDUSTRY

The wealth of many of today's developed countries came originally from heavy industries such as steel production, oil refining, vehicle manufacturing, railroads, and shipbuilding (right). All of these enterprises require a huge investment in buildings and equipment, and use a lot of raw materials and fuel. They also need large, skilled workforces.



▲ SKILLED WORK

Many light industries rely on the hands-on skills of their workers. These American technicians are assembling the main circuit boards of computers.

LIGHT INDUSTRY

With a reliable supply of electricity, small workshops can be set up almost anywhere. Many use traditional crafts such as woodworking or dressmaking, but others use new technology. Large or small, these companies are often at the cutting edge of research, making key breakthroughs in electronics, medicine, and new materials.

SERVICE INDUSTRY

Many modern industries do not produce any goods that you can touch. Instead, they provide services such as banking and finance, legal advice, or insurance. The London Stock Exchange (right) provides a service for investors worldwide, but your local hospital, restaurant, and movie theater provide services too.

